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ARTICLE

JD Vance Says The Antichrist May Be Walking Among Us - Could He Be Right?





BY PNW STAFF SEPTEMBER 02, 2026

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Vice President JD Vance made a remarkable comment this week that is certain to catch the attention of anyone who studies Bible prophecy.

During a lengthy conversation with Christian podcaster Bryce Crawford, Vance discussed his lifelong fascination with the end times and admitted that he does not know whether we are actually living in the final days described in Scripture.

But then he went further.

"There are, like, things about the world that make me feel, like, not shocked if the Antichrist was walking among us," Vance said, while cautioning that he tries not to become overly focused on such speculation.

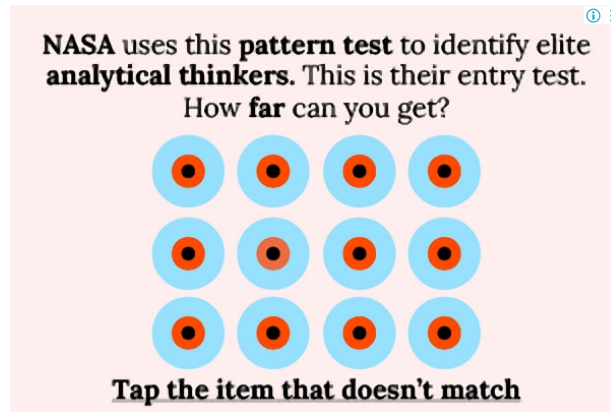
Vance pointed particularly to developments surrounding artificial intelligence, describing what he sees in parts of the technology world as having a strange spiritual darkness surrounding it. Yet his larger observation raises a fascinating question.

Could the Antichrist actually be alive today?

From a biblical perspective, the answer is certainly possible.

That does not mean we should start searching photographs of politicians, billionaires or world leaders trying to identify him. Christians have been doing that for generations, usually with embarrassing results. But if the prophetic events described in Daniel, 2 Thessalonians and Revelation are approaching, then the man who will eventually fulfill this role would obviously have to be alive before he is revealed to the world.

And Scripture gives us something of a profile by which this coming leader can eventually be recognized.



### The Antichrist Will Be A Real Person

The Bible describes a spirit of antichrist already operating in the world, but it also points toward a specific individual who will emerge during the closing chapter of human history.

Daniel describes an extraordinarily powerful ruler. Paul calls him the "man of lawlessness" and "son of destruction." Revelation presents him as the Beast whose authority eventually reaches across nations and peoples.

This is not merely an impersonal political system. Scripture repeatedly describes an individual who speaks, acts, deceives, makes agreements, persecutes God's people and ultimately exalts himself against God.

But here is where our popular image of the Antichrist may lead us astray.

He may not initially look anything like the monster people expect.

### He Will Initially Appear To Have Answers

Many Christians imagine the Antichrist arriving as an obviously evil dictator demanding that everyone worship him.

That comes later.

His initial rise appears far more subtle.

Daniel describes a leader who gains tremendous influence through intrigue and deception. Daniel 8:25 even describes destruction coming "by peace" in the King James rendering. Most significantly, Daniel 9:27 describes a coming ruler who will "confirm a covenant with many for one week."

In Daniel's prophetic framework, interpreters understand that final "week" as a seven-year period. Because the prophecy centers upon Daniel's people, Jerusalem, the sanctuary and the restoration and eventual interruption of sacrifice, the covenant is commonly understood as a major agreement involving Israel and "many" other parties or nations.

That detail is enormously significant.

The Antichrist does not simply appear on the world stage announcing himself as a dictator. His rise is associated with a covenant that apparently provides some measure of political or religious security and stability involving Israel.

In other words, the man who eventually becomes history's greatest tyrant may first become famous as a peacemaker.

And consider how attractive such a figure could become in our world.

Humanity is exhausted by war. The Middle East has endured generations of bloodshed. Russia and Europe remain locked in dangerous confrontation. Nuclear powers threaten one another while nations spend enormous sums preparing for conflicts they desperately hope never occur.

People don't want another war.

They want someone who can stop them.

Imagine, then, a leader emerging during an international crisis who accomplishes what everyone else has failed to achieve. He brings hostile governments to the table. He provides security guarantees. He negotiates agreements previously considered impossible. Perhaps he resolves disputes surrounding Israel and its neighbors that generations of diplomats could not solve.

The world would not necessarily view such a man as evil.



It might view him as indispensable.



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### **The Man The World Has Been Waiting For?**

This is one of the great ironies of Bible prophecy.

The world's ultimate tyrant may initially be celebrated as its greatest problem solver.

He may speak about peace, cooperation, stability and security. He may appear uniquely capable of bringing order from chaos.

And successful deception requires appearing to be something you are not.

The peace eventually collapses.

Daniel says that halfway through the seven-year period -- after three and a half years -- this ruler breaks the covenant and brings sacrifice and offering to an end. Jesus later points His disciples back to Daniel's prophecy when He warns about the coming "abomination of desolation" standing in the holy place.

Revelation describes this latter period as an extraordinary time of persecution and satanic authority. The Beast is given authority for 42 months -- three and a half years -- while Paul says the "man of lawlessness" will ultimately exalt himself "above all that is called God" and present himself as God.

The implications are striking. The prophetic timeline moves from covenant to betrayal, from apparent peace to persecution, and from a leader celebrated for bringing stability to a ruler demanding allegiance and worship.

The peacemaker finally reveals himself as the tyrant.

### **A World Increasingly Ready For Such A Leader**

This is where Vance's question becomes particularly relevant.

We cannot know whether the Antichrist is presently alive. Scripture gives us no license to identify someone before the prophetic markers are present.

But we can observe that the world described by prophecy is becoming technologically and politically easier to imagine.

We now possess global communications capable of projecting one leader instantly before billions of people. Artificial intelligence can influence information on an unprecedented scale. Digital currencies and payment systems make previously unimaginable economic controls technically possible. Biometrics and digital identification increasingly connect individuals to centralized technological systems.

Meanwhile, international instability is creating enormous demand for security and leadership.

None of these things individually fulfills Revelation.

AI is not the Antichrist. Digital ID is not automatically the Mark of the Beast. A Middle East peace agreement is not necessarily Daniel's covenant.

But collectively they demonstrate something remarkable: the technological and geopolitical architecture necessary for many end-times scenarios no longer sounds like science fiction.

### **Don't Look For The Obvious Villain**

Perhaps the most important lesson is that Christians should stop assuming the Antichrist will initially look like the Antichrist.

If Scripture portrays him as deceptive, persuasive and politically successful, the world's first reaction to him may not be fear.

It may be relief.

After years of wars, economic turmoil, political division and constant threats of something worse, humanity could become desperate for someone promising peace and stability.

That is why the biblical warning is ultimately about deception.

JD Vance may be right that the individual who will someday fulfill these prophecies could already be walking among us.

He could be young. He could currently be unknown. He could already occupy some position of influence. Or his appearance could still be generations away.

We simply don't know.

What Scripture tells us is far more important.

When he finally emerges, don't expect the world to immediately recognize a monster.

It may initially believe it has finally found a peacemaker.

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